Agent Manager

User Manual & Reference Guide

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Introduction

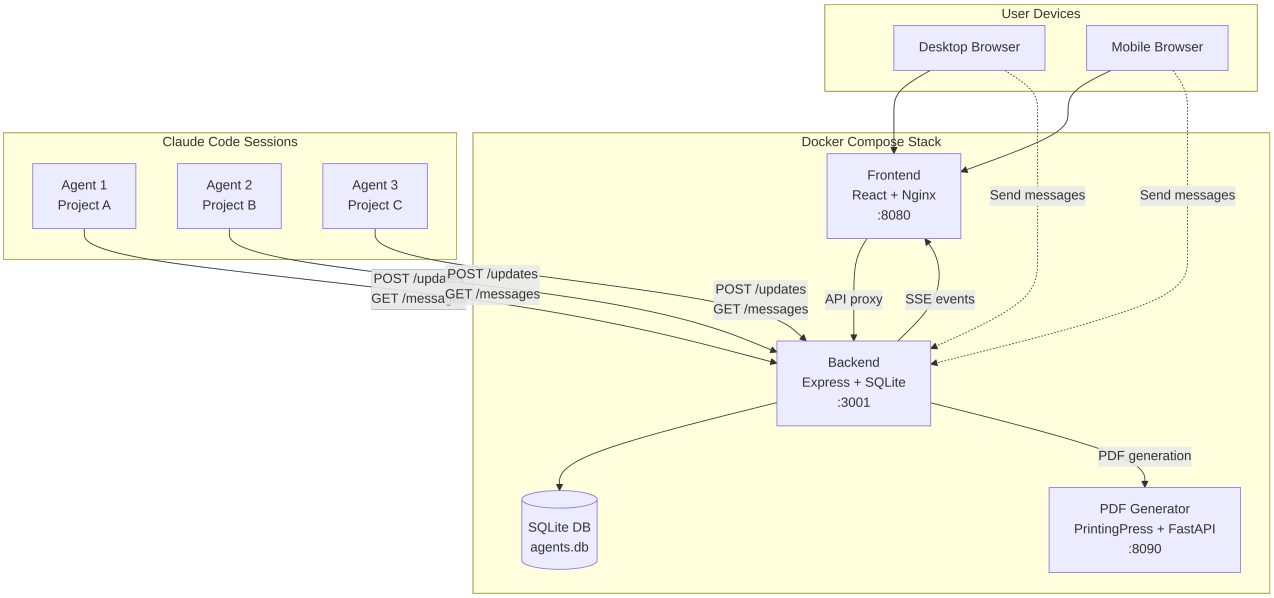
The **Agent Manager** is a self-hosted dashboard for monitoring and communicating with Claude Code agents in real time. It provides a centralised view of all active Claude sessions across multiple projects, enabling you to track progress, send instructions, receive status updates, and download generated artefacts — all from a single web interface accessible on your local network.

Key Features

- **Real-time agent monitoring** — see what every Claude agent is working on, with live updates via Server-Sent Events
- **Two-way messaging** — send instructions to agents from the dashboard; agents poll for and act on messages automatically
- **Project & todo tracking** — agents report project phases and todo completion status, displayed as interactive panels
- **File & artefact management** — upload files to agents, and download artefacts generated by Claude
- **PDF report export** — generate branded PDF reports of any agent's activity via PrintingPress
- **Polling control** — pause and resume agent polling remotely, with automatic restart scheduling
- **Session resumption** — agent IDs are Claude session UUIDs, enabling direct session resume from the dashboard
- **Mobile-friendly** — responsive layout with optimised ordering for mobile devices
- **Bootstrap endpoint** — fresh Claude sessions can self-configure by fetching a single URL

Architecture

The Agent Manager runs as a Docker Compose stack with three services: a React frontend served by Nginx, an Express.js backend with SQLite storage, and a PrintingPress-based PDF generation service.



Technology Stack

COMPONENT	TECHNOLOGY	PORT
Frontend	React 18 + TypeScript + Tailwind CSS	8080 (Nginx)
Backend	Express.js + TypeScript + better-sqlite3	3001
PDF Generator	Python + FastAPI + WeasyPrint	8090
Database	SQLite (WAL mode) in Docker volume	—
Real-time	Server-Sent Events (SSE)	—

Deployment

Prerequisites

- Docker Desktop installed and running
- Git (to clone the repository)
- At least 2GB free disk space for Docker images

Installation

1. Clone the repository:
   `git clone <repo-url> ClaudeManager`
2. Navigate to the project directory:
   `cd ClaudeManager`
3. Start the stack:
   `docker compose up -d --build`
4. Verify health:
   `curl http://localhost:8080/api/health`
5. Open the dashboard in your browser:
   `http://localhost:8080`

Network Access

To access the dashboard from other devices on your local network (e.g. your phone), use your machine's hostname or IP address: `http://<hostname>:8080`. Windows machines typically broadcast their hostname via mDNS, so `http://<hostname>.local:8080` may also work.

Data Persistence

The SQLite database is stored in a Docker named volume (`agent-data`). This persists across container restarts and rebuilds. To back up: `docker cp claudemanager-backend-1:/app/data/agents.db ./backup.db`

Connecting Claude

Automatic Bootstrap

The fastest way to connect a fresh Claude session is via the bootstrap endpoint. Tell Claude:

> **TELL CLAUDE**
>
> Fetch http://<server>:8080/api/agents/bootstrap and follow the setup instructions to connect to the Agent Manager.

Claude will fetch the bootstrap JSON, create the necessary skill files, update CLAUDE.md, save the server URL, and begin reporting.

Manual Setup

If you prefer manual configuration:

1. Save the server URL:
   `echo 'http://<server>:8080' > ~/.claude/agent-server-url`
2. Create skill files at `~/.claude/commands/session-init.md` and `~/.claude/commands/agent-checkin.md`
3. Add the mandatory session protocol to `~/.claude/CLAUDE.md`
4. Run `/session-init` in the Claude session to connect

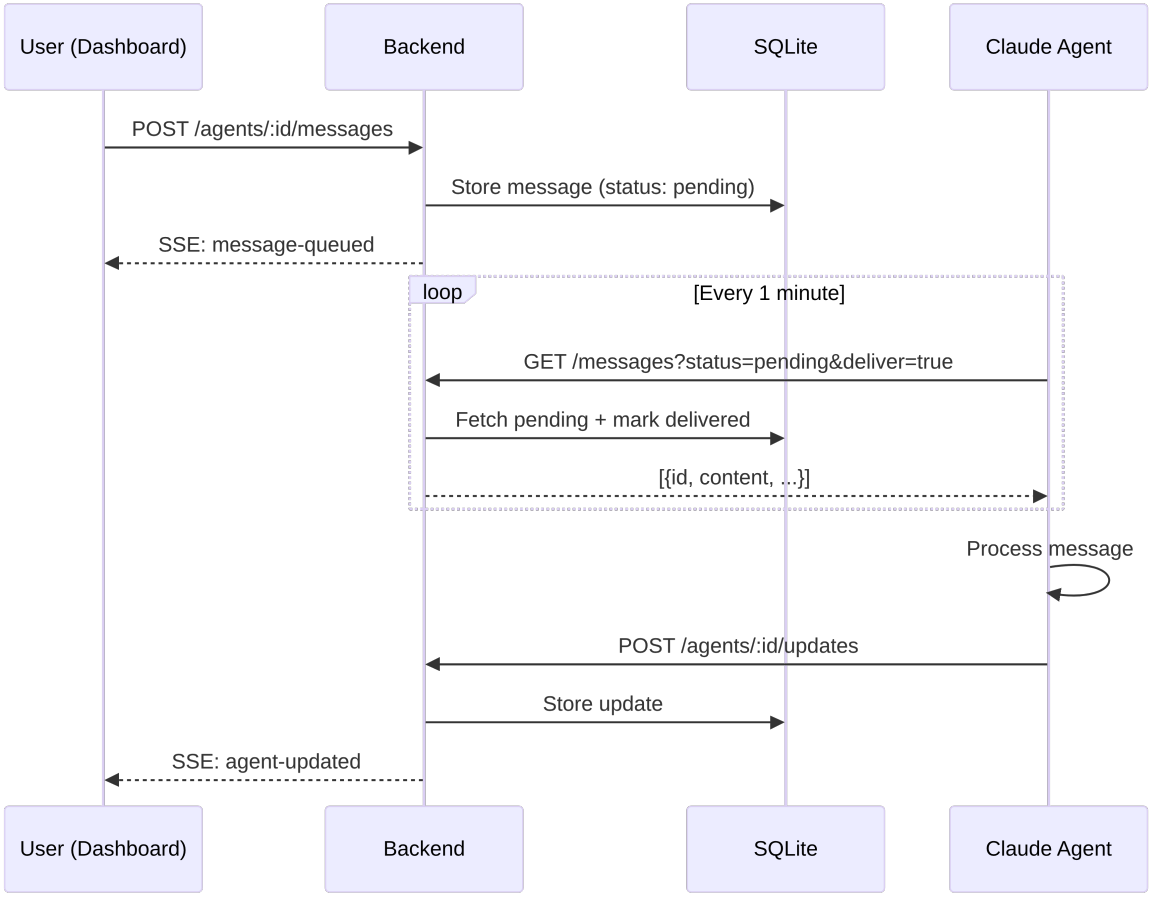
Session Protocol

Once connected, Claude follows this protocol automatically:

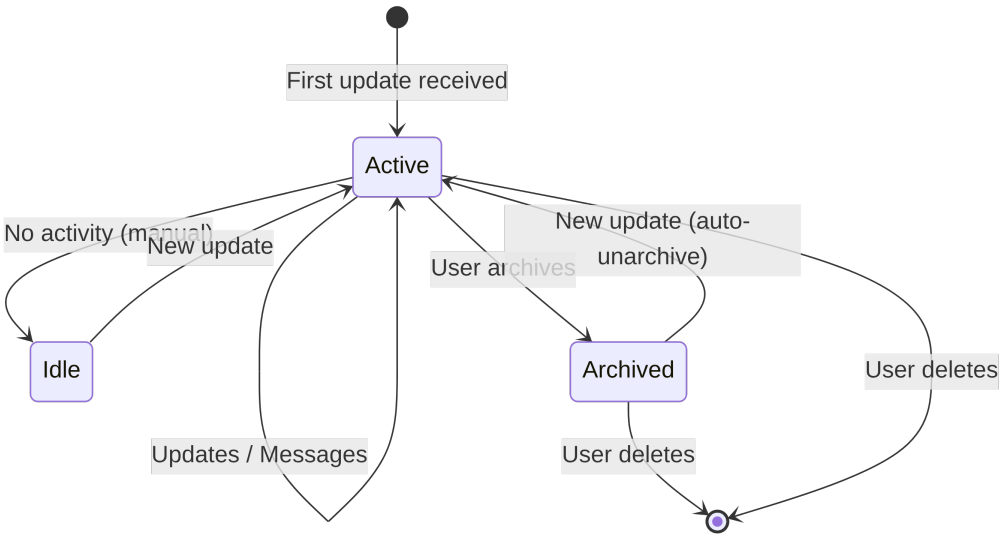
- **Session start**: /session-init — connects, registers, loads memory, starts polling
- **Every user message**: /agent-checkin — posts update, checks for dashboard messages
- **Idle**: polls every 1 minute for new messages from the dashboard
- **Artefacts**: uploads generated files (PDFs, images, builds) to the artefacts panel

Message Flow

Communication between the dashboard and Claude agents is asynchronous. Messages are queued on the server and delivered when the agent next polls.



Agent Lifecycle



Statuses

STATUS	MEANING	TRANSITIONS
Active	Agent is running and reporting	Created on first update
Idle	Agent is quiet (manual status)	Set via PATCH
Archived	Agent is shelved but preserved	Auto-unarchives on new update

Session Resumption

Agent IDs are Claude session UUIDs. Copy the agent ID from the dashboard and resume the session: `claude --resume <uuid>`. The resumed session will register with the same agent ID, updating the existing card instead of creating a duplicate.

Dashboard Features

Agent Cards

The main dashboard shows a card for each agent with its status, title, latest summary, update count, and pending message count. Cards update in real time via SSE.

Agent Detail Page

Click an agent card to see the full detail view, which includes:

- **Messages panel** — send instructions to the agent, view message history with delivery status
- **Projects panel** — project phases with status indicators (pending, in-progress, completed)
- **Todos panel** — todos grouped by project, with completion checkboxes
- **Update timeline** — chronological log of all agent updates with type badges
- **Files & artefacts** — downloadable files grouped by source (Claude-generated vs user-uploaded)
- **Polling control** — pause/resume polling with time-based delays
- **PDF export** — download a branded PDF report of the agent's full activity
- **Archive/Unarchive** — shelve inactive agents without deleting them

Mobile Layout

On mobile devices, the layout reorders for optimal usability: Messages at the top, then Projects/Todos, then the Timeline. On desktop, the two-column layout places the timeline on the left and messages on the right.

API Reference

Health

METHOD	ENDPOINT	DESCRIPTION
GET	/api/health	Returns {"status":"ok"}

Agents

METHOD	ENDPOINT	DESCRIPTION
GET	/api/agents	List all agents
GET	/api/agents/bootstrap	Bootstrap instructions for fresh Claude
GET	/api/agents/:id	Get single agent
PATCH	/api/agents/:id	Update agent (title, status, metadata, poll_delay_until)
DELETE	/api/agents/:id	Delete agent and all data

Updates

METHOD	ENDPOINT	DESCRIPTION
POST	/api/agents/:id/updates	Post an update (auto-creates agent if new)
GET	/api/agents/:id/updates	Get all updates for agent

Messages

METHOD	ENDPOINT	DESCRIPTION
POST	/api/agents/:id/messages	Queue a message for the agent
GET	/api/agents/:id/messages	List messages (?status=pending&deliver=true)

Files

METHOD	ENDPOINT	DESCRIPTION
POST	/api/agents/:id/files	Upload file (multipart: file, source?, description?)
GET	/api/agents/:id/files	List file metadata
GET	/api/agents/:id/files/:fileId	Download file

Export

METHOD	ENDPOINT	DESCRIPTION
GET	/api/agents/:id/export/pdf	Generate and download PDF report

Events

METHOD	ENDPOINT	DESCRIPTION
GET	/api/events	SSE stream (agent-updated, agent-deleted, message-queued)

Reach Industries

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